

Concerning Nibbāna (Fourth Discourse)

Catutthanibbānapaṭisaṃyuttasutta (Ud 8.4)

Evam me sutam— ekaṃ samayaṃ bhagavā sāvatthiyaṃ viharati jetavane
anāthapiṇḍikassa ārāme. Tena kho pana samayena bhagavā bhikkhū
nibbānapaṭisaṃyuttāya dhammiyā kathāya sandasseti samādapeti samuttejeti
sampaharṇseti. Tedha bhikkhū aṭṭhiṃ katvā manasi katvā sabbam cetaso
samannāharitvā ohitasotā dhammam suṇanti.

Thus have I heard— At one time the Blessed One was staying near Sāvattihī in Jeta's Grove, Anāthapiṇḍika's monastery. At that time, the Blessed One instructed, encouraged, inspired, and gladdened the monks with a talk on the Dhamma (*dhamma*) concerning final liberation (*nibbāna*). And those monks, paying thorough attention, taking it to heart, and concentrating with their whole mind, listened to the Dhamma with rapt attention.

Atha kho bhagavā etamattham viditvā tāyaṃ velāyaṃ imaṃ udānaṃ udānesi:

“Nissitassa calitaṃ, anissitassa calitaṃ natthi. Calite asati passaddhi, passaddhiyā
sati nati na hoti. Natiyā asati āgatigati na hoti. Āgatigatiyā asati cutūpapāto na hoti.
Cutūpapāte asati nevidha na huram na ubhayamantarena. Esevanto dukkhassā”ti.

Then the Blessed One, understanding the significance of this, uttered this inspired utterance at that time:

"For one who clings, there is wavering; for one who does not cling, there is no wavering. When there is no wavering, there is stillness; when there is stillness, there is no inclination. When there is no inclination, there is no coming and going. When there is no coming and going, there is no passing away and rebirth. When there is no passing away and rebirth, there is neither a 'here' nor a 'there' nor anything in between. This, indeed, is the end of suffering (*dukkha*)."

Glossary

Pāli (IAST)	Target transliteration	Target gloss	First-chapter occurrence	Goenka-tradition usage
nibbāna	nibbāna	final liberation	Nibbāna Sutta	The ultimate state of peace

Pāli (IAST)	Target transliteration	Target gloss	First-chapter occurrence	Goenka-tradition usage
				and liberation from all suffering, attained by extinguishing the fires of craving, aversion, and ignorance.
dhamma	Dhamma	the teaching; the universal law	Nibbāna Sutta	Capitalized to denote the universal law of nature and the path taught by the Buddha.
calita	calita	wavering	Nibbāna Sutta	The instability or movement of the mind when it reacts to sensory objects with craving or aversion.
passaddhi	passaddhi	stillness; tranquility	Nibbāna Sutta	The deep tranquility and calmness of the mind when it is free from wavering and reactions.
nati	nati	inclination; bending	Nibbāna Sutta	The bending or leaning of the mind towards objects of attachment, generating

Pāli (IAST)	Target transliteration	Target gloss	First-chapter occurrence	Goenka-tradition usage
				subsequent reactions.
dukkha	dukkha	suffering	Nibbāna Sutta	The inherent unsatisfactoriness of conditioned existence.

Translator Notes

1. **Intimate Teacher-to-Student Voice:** The English translation maintains a direct and experiential tone, translating the Buddha's concise statement with simple and powerful language that reflects the meditative process of self-observation.
2. **Wavering (*Calita*) and Stillness (*Passaddhi*):** Translated *calita* as "wavering" to represent the unstable, reactive nature of the mind when it clings (*nissita*). The opposite, *passaddhi*, is translated as "stillness" to denote the deep, non-reactive peace of a mind established in equanimity.
3. **Inclination (*Nati*):** Rendered as "inclination" to capture the subtle mental bending or leaning of the mind towards or away from sensations before full-blown craving and aversion manifest.
4. **Coming and Going (*Āgatigatī*) and Passing Away and Rebirth (*Cutūpapāto*):** Metaphorically, these represent the macro-cycle of rebirth in samsara, and phenomenologically, they describe the micro-cycle of the arising and passing away of conditioned mental states.